PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | SOC Tier 2 / Tier 3 | Microsoft Defender XDR | Vulnerability Management

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of hands-on Security Operations Centre (SOC) experience at Tier 2 and Tier 3 level, specialising in threat detection, incident investigation, and end-to-end vulnerability management. In my current role at the University of the Arts London, I operate as a Senior Cyber Security Analyst and Engineer, leading alert triage and incident response using Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR), Microsoft Entra ID, and Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) platforms including CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel. I am proficient in querying and analysing log data using Kusto Query Language (KQL), applying the MITRE ATT&CK framework to map adversary techniques and improve detection coverage, and using Common Vulnerability Scoring System (CVSS) and NIST scoring to prioritise vulnerability remediation. I am a strong communicator who works effectively across technical and non-technical teams, driving measurable security improvements and reducing organisational risk.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SOC Operations:** Tier 2 and Tier 3 alert triage, threat investigation, Security Operations Centre (SOC) processes, escalation management and incident lifecycle ownership
- **SIEM / EDR / SOAR:** Microsoft Sentinel, CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM; Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development; CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent, Insight, Discover
- **Microsoft Security Ecosystem:** Microsoft Defender XDR (Extended Detection and Response), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, Microsoft Defender for Office 365
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Privileged Identity Management (PIM), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Vulnerability Management (End-to-End):** Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS); scan-to-remediation lifecycle management
- **Threat Intelligence and Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, Common Vulnerability Scoring System (CVSS), CISA Known Exploited Vulnerabilities (KEV), NIST, Cyber Essentials Plus
- **Log Analysis and Querying:** KQL (Kusto Query Language), SPL (Splunk Processing Language), log correlation and threat hunting
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61, root cause analysis, containment and eradication, post-incident review
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, SOAR automation playbooks
- **Frameworks:** NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) *March 2025 - Present*

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Operate as a Tier 3 analyst across a Security Operations Centre (SOC) function protecting more than 8,000 users, leading complex incident investigations from initial alert through to root cause analysis, containment, and eradication.
- Perform threat detection and investigation using Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, correlating multi-source telemetry to identify advanced attack patterns.
- Engineer KQL (Kusto Query Language) analytics rules in Microsoft Sentinel, improving detection coverage for identity-based attacks, lateral movement, privilege escalation, and data exfiltration mapped to the MITRE ATT&CK framework.

- Lead end-to-end vulnerability management using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), prioritising remediation using CVSS scoring and CISA Known Exploited Vulnerabilities (KEV) guidance, and tracking remediation milestones to completion.
- Manage Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) identity security, including Conditional Access policies, MFA enforcement, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), and investigation of identity-based threats using Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI).
- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), controlling and auditing privileged account access to reduce standing privilege risk.
- Develop SOAR automation playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel to automate alert enrichment, threat containment, and ticketing workflows, reducing mean time to respond and freeing analyst capacity for higher-value investigations.
- Conduct proactive threat hunting campaigns using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and KQL, identifying and remediating undetected threats aligned to current MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques.
- Respond to security incidents following NIST 800-61 procedures, producing detailed incident reports and post-incident reviews for senior stakeholders.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) *March 2022 - March 2025*

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Monitored and triaged Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) alerts across CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel, managing incidents through the full lifecycle using NIST 800-61 response procedures.
- Participated in the deployment and operationalisation of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across an estate of 8,000+ users.
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) including Conditional Access policy configuration, identity governance review, and privileged role auditing.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Nessus, applying CVSS scoring to prioritise and track remediation of critical and high-severity findings.
- Deployed and managed Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM) policies across managed and bring-your-own-device (BYOD) endpoints.
- Supported incident response and forensic investigations, applying the MITRE ATT&CK framework to map adversary behaviours and inform detection improvements.
- Developed PowerShell scripts for automated alert enrichment, account lifecycle management, and compliance reporting.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS / FinTech) *February 2021 - March 2022*

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Delivered IT infrastructure and security support for a Software-as-a-Service (SaaS) FinTech organisation, maintaining compliance with ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus.
- Administered Microsoft Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) and Microsoft 365, managing user identities, access controls, and security group policies.
- Monitored endpoint security, managed patch deployment, and configured antivirus and device compliance policies.
- Supported security incident investigations and contributed to security awareness and risk management activities.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across a 8,000+ user estate - the largest security platform rollout in UAL's history - delivering full endpoint and identity telemetry coverage within project timelines.
- Authored over 20 KQL (Kusto Query Language) detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel, improving SOC detection coverage for identity-based attacks, lateral movement, and data exfiltration scenarios.
- Reduced alert triage time by approximately 35% through SOAR automation playbook development and detection tuning in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM.
- Led UAL's Cyber Essentials Plus certification renewal, coordinating end-to-end vulnerability remediation of over 150 identified findings within the required timeframe.
- Achieved CISSP certification, validating expertise across all eight domains of the CISSP Common Body of Knowledge (CBK).

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)